

Scenario Overview

Once a bustling fishing port, the coastal town of **Kingsport** in Tennessee now lies under a veil of dread. Over the past two years, the seas have grown increasingly hostile, decimating the local fishing industry. Boats mysteriously disappear, reefs appear where none should be, and monstrous shapes lurk beneath the waves.

The Investigators are commissioned by the **Kingsport Fishing Company (KPF)** to uncover the source of the phenomenon and, if possible, put an end to the town's misfortune.

Keeper's Information & Themes

1. Keeper's Secrets

- **Two Years Ago:** A salvaging crew on a ship named "Poseidon", discovered a strange, blue-covered book dredged up from the ocean with the other salvage. The entity known as "**Cerulean It**" is sealed inside the book and exerts its corrupting influence on the town with the help of **Burns**, a crewmate that it brought back to life. It sees the soul and mind of people as food, and gains power as it devours them, waiting to break the seal and emerge into the world.
- Players must collect the mercury pendant to maintain their sanity, the phosphorus light to wade off "true darkness", and salt water to kill the reed monsters, and finally access the 5th floor library for a faceoff against Burns to throw the book back to sea.

2. Recommended Skills

- **Library Use, Spot Hidden**
 - **Combat Skills**
 - **Vehicle driving**
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Investigators' Hooks

1. **Commissioned by Kingsport Fishing Company:** The Investigators are hired to figure out why fishing vessels keep sinking and how to restore the once-thriving industry.
 2. **Personal Vengeance:** One Investigator lost a loved one or something precious to the sea; the yearning drives them to investigate this mystery.
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Setting: Kingsport, Tennessee

- **Overview:** A coastal town that thrived on fishing until two years ago. Now, storms and monstrous incidents have left the community desperate.
 - **Atmosphere:** Gloom and uncertainty. Locals are wary of strangers and resigned to their fate. The shores are foggy and the nights are dark.
 - **Notable Locations:**
 1. **KPF Office & Workshop** (commissioners' HQ)
 2. **Police Station**
 3. **Kingsport Public Library**
 4. **Harbor & Sea Cottages**Beach
 5. **Abandoned Lighthouse**
 6. **The Seaside Bar**
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Special Rules

Character creation: Each player must have something important to them that they lost at sea. These will manifest in the town to lure them into danger or to complete the ritual unleashing cerulean it, which promise to bring back what they have lost.

Fortitude checks: When a player is corrupted by the cerulean it, either by contacting the blue ink, eating books, or direct confrontation, they trigger a fortitude check. When this happens, players are forbidden to look at their character sheet, and the Keeper asks them information regarding their past or their identity. Failure to answer will increase an invisible "Shaken" level and further warp player perception. Each player starts at 0 Shaken level and transforms into a book once they reach the 4th Shaken level.

Death Door: When a player reaches indefinite insanity or dies at OHP, instead enter **Death Door**, where a 1d6 is rolled to determine what happens. If the number is Higher than **The Threshold**, the player dies/goes crazy. Otherwise, choose from the permanent insanity table for a permanent negative quirk, and heal 1d4HP/1d4 sanity. If a 1 is rolled, the player instead rises from adversity and attains a temporary or permanent buff from the virtue table. **The Threshold** starts at 6 and reduces by 1 each time the player hits death's door.

Locations and events

The Scenario is a sandbox, and places can be accessed in any order. However, the keeper should aim to let players sail to the abandoned lighthouse only after the first day, and let players access the 5th floor library (final area) only on the last day.

Beginning: KPF headquarters

Location: Kingsport Fishing Company (KPF) Headquarters

- **Briefing:** The Investigators meet with **Mr. Carver**, a representative of KPF. He explains:
 - Over the past two years, all fishing trips have ended in disaster—crew missing, vessels wrecked. The sea is eternally shrouded in fog.
 - No one understands why the sea has become so hostile, and the players are tasked with finding the cause of this situation and resolving it so fishing can again flourish.
 - An overview of the town is given and the players are pointed to the town library and police station
 - **Resources:**
 - The fishing company provides food and housing to the investigating party, as well as a ship on the second day if the players choose to explore the lighthouse. The ship is rented to them and the player that rents it must have at least 30 credit rating to receive it.
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Police Station

Key NPC: Officer **Heath**, the only one willing to help. Other officers are dismissive.

- **Heath's Back Story:**
 - His wife worked on a fishing vessel that vanished at sea months ago. He still receives messages in drifting bottles, claiming she'll "be home soon," even though all evidence says her shipwrecked long ago. Through this experience, Heath developed a fear of the sea.
- **Records:** A successful **Social Skills check**, **Credit Rating** check or other methods of convincing Heath gives the following information:
 - A rise in **mysterious disappearances** for two years, spiking recently.
 - **Reporter Graves**, the famous reporter, vanished during an investigation
 - **Wanted:** "Hunter," for vandalism (destruction of library property, theft and murder).
 - Eye-witness accounts of a **ghost ship** sailing at night and bodies washing ashore.
- Failure in social check will result in the officer lying that Kingsport is a peaceful town with nothing unusual going on.

- If at any point the players call the police that causes Heath to see an eldritch monster, a hollow body or anything supernatural, he will share the police records with players more willingly and ask them to investigate.

Heath has a **fear of the sea** and will not go near it. Mentioning his backstory regarding Eurydice and trying to recruit Heath can cause him to become an ally.

The Library

Appearance & Layout:

1. **Ground Floor (1F):** History & Geography. Borrow desk with a “book exchange” policy (you must return one to borrow one). For valuable books, the library asks for your “book donation” from a donation list, with the books on the list being manifestations of the player’s memories, name, or other parts of their identity.
2. **Second Floor (2F):** Literature & Occult.
 - a. The section on biographies of people contains a high density of books that were originally people. The contents of such books describe their experiences, thoughts and memories. The pages are stained with blue ink. Seeing or contacting the blue ink triggers **Fortitude Check** and deals *1d4 - 1d10 sanity damage* depending on the method of contact.
 - b. Possible Notes in books on 2F:
 - i. Do not compare. Do not doubt. There is only one shade of blue.
 - ii. [Written in blue ink] To recover from the cold of the sea, one must eat and drink before going out.
 - iii. I am so tenaciously close to the truth, yet I feel its bulging eyes and cerulean gaze.
3. **Third Floor (3F):** Scientific journals & marine biology sections
 - a. Kingsport is in a good location where marine life flourish due to the mild weather and warm currents of the sea
 - b. Information regarding the Krakens at sea
4. **Fourth Floor (4F):** Restricted Archives & the Burn’s Office
 - a. The restricted Archives is managed by Price the librarian. If the players state their request, Price will aid in fetching whatever material from the archive for them to read. However, they may not take them away.
 - i. The list of ships that disappeared or crashed at sea. The number has drastically increased starting from two years ago, with the first ship being “Poseidon”

5. **Hidden Fifth Floor:** Where cerulean it is kept. Inaccessible until the very end, where players either bring it food(books) or enter through gaining the trust of the Order of the Wise.

Encounters:

- **Price, the Library Staffer:** She tries to keep Investigators away from the 4th floor. Perceptive players may notice occult runes on her clothing. She lost her child to a drowning accident, muttering “blood and ink” in her sleep.
- **Strange “Darkness”:** Late at night, lights fail. Investigators risk encountering humanoid monsters made of reeds and paper.
- **Scattered Clues:**
 - **Newspaper Reports** of reporter Graves’s disappearance.
 - **Sea Disasters:** Accidents track back to the *Poseidon* salvage two years prior.
 - **Ship Log Copies:** Mentions Burns, the wheelchair-bound crewman, who was caught cheating at cards. Mentions a bizarre, scaly presence following the ship.
 - **Crew’s Journal** Fragments:
 - 17 Jan: “Good weather. The dredging is going well. I sat and played some cards with the wheelchair man and caught him cheating. It’s rude to argue with a dying man, so I left it there.”
 - 22 Jan: “Much has been done today, but loathsome shadows swirl around the ship”
 - 25 Jan: “Hunter went mad and attacked the captain... He was shot in the chest and thrown overboard. The deck is stained with blood and ink.

Hidden Fifth Floor:

- Dim corridors filled with an oppressive hush. “**Cerulean It**” exerts its influence here.
 - Enormous standing mirrors reflect “wrong” images, leading to partial SAN drains if Investigators stare too long.
 - Shelves stretch unnaturally, books crawling like living things. The deeper the party goes, the more the environment warps with ink illusions and patches of “total darkness.”
 - **Climax Possibility:** The *Blue Book* or the *Librarian (Burns)* may attempt a ritual to feed souls to “Cerulean It.”
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Streetside Tarot Shop

Beach and beachside house

Abandoned Lighthouse

Gemstone Tavern

Graves residence

While the library is the epicenter, Investigators may explore further:

1. Harbor & Sea Cottages

- Ramshackle huts with elderly fishers like **Gwen**, who saw the *Poseidon* sink. She heard wailing from the water as if the ocean itself were furious. Gwen might lend a small boat if the Investigators promise to cast the cursed book into the sea—though that might be exactly what “Cerulean It” wants.

2. Abandoned Lighthouse

- **Hunter’s Hideout:** Guarded by his own “salt men.” Inside are jars containing strange lumps of mercury and phosphorus—pieces of stolen souls?
- Hunter’s scrawled notes: “**Burn the book, smash the glass. A mindless husk cannot be corrupted.**”
- If confronted, Hunter might attempt to *ally* with the Investigators if they share a common enemy: the cursed book. Alternatively, he may be so paranoid he attacks on sight.

3. The Emerald Tavern

- Locals discuss an unpublished novel by “HP,” rumored to be about robbers who vanished after stealing from an old sailor—likely referencing Hunter.
- Talk of a missing musician named **Eurydice**, once a performer on the *Poseidon*, whose haunting melodies might still echo from some ghostly wreck.

4. Graves’ Residence

- A newer reporter named **Amber** may be secretly rummaging through Graves’ notes.
 - A trap door to the cellar reveals a flooded chamber tinted with blue ink. Graves’ body floats in the ink, half-transformed. His final note:
 - “**Only a burning soul can pierce the darkness. Only a resolute mind can endure the madness. Only a living vessel can cleanse these abominations.**”
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Chapter 5: Venturing Onto the Sea

Eventually, the Investigators may decide to **take a boat** (from KPF, Gwen, or by stealing one) to investigate the restless waters or the wreck of the *Poseidon*.

- **Thick Fog:** Low visibility; possible illusions of ghost ships or singing sirens.
- **“Salt Constructs”:** Lurking in the mist, half-human lumps of salt that attempt to board.
- **Sunken Remains:** If they dive or explore the wreck, they find evidence that the *Poseidon* truly carried the dreaded blue grimoire.
- **Sirens / Sea Monsters:** Grotesque, slow-moving masses resembling human lungs with lamprey-like mouths. They mimic the dead musician’s songs, luring Investigators to madness.

Outcome: If the Investigators bring the cursed book to the sea, they must decide whether to **throw it back** (risking “Cerulean It” fully awakening) or **destroy it** (though it resists normal fire and water damage).

Chapter 6: The fifth floor

Falling action: The Escape

Major NPCs

1. **Burns**
 - Former *Poseidon* crewman, terminally ill but “cured” by the book.
 - Has funded the library to **protect** the cerulean it, the primary antagonist of the scenario.
 - Will try whatever he can to mislead the players into thinking Hunter is the culprit, or that the sea is the culprit and must be cleansed.
2. **Hunter**
 - A old fisherman rumored to have died on the *Poseidon* but somehow survived.
 - Dedicated to *destroying* the cursed book by any means—smashing mirrors, burning pages, purging the corrupted and turning them into metallic cubes. Creates salt constructs for his own vigilante war.
3. **Officer Heath**
 - Tormented policeman whose wife vanished at sea.
 - Potential ally with access to police records and moderate authority.
4. **Price** (4th floor Library Staff)
 - An unwitting cultist or borderline maddened figure wearing runes to stay “safe.”

- Lost her child to drowning and believes the cursed book has answers.
 - 5. **Mr. Carver** (KPF worker)
 - Official sponsor of the investigation
 - Polite but clueless about the occult magnitude of the problem.
 - 6. **Reporter Graves** (Old reporter. Dead)
 - Found dead in his own basement
 - Left behind notes that piece together the final puzzle.
 - 7. **Amber** (New Reporter)
 - Investigating Graves' disappearance.
 - Potential ally that shares information with the PC. Fearful, will hide and run if danger approaches.
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Endings

1. **Throw it back**
 - Tossing the time overboard permanently seals cerulean it under the icy waters once more.
 - blue to cyan, second sky
2. **Complete the ritual/ Fail**

The sea becomes the eerie blue of madness. Water rises, bloody reeds emerge from the waters as buildings are submerged by it. Cerulean It descends upon the world under a liquid sky.

Status Tables

Madness Table

Virtue Table

Shaken Table

Shaken Level	Questions	Consequence
1	The PC's name and	Player will see see

	occupation	
2		
3		
4	Basic human anatomy and biology. ()	Player is turned into a book

Keeper Advice

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